The Lazaurian Oath

The Oath

"I will use my mind to restore the health of all creatures with sympathy, compassion, and heedfulness
I will use my hands to be able to prepare medicines well
I will use my eyes to know what medicine is suitable and what is not. I will not give the unsuitable, only the suitable.
I will use my heart to minister to the sick with an attitude of love, not out of desire for gain.
I will use my legs to remain with the sick wherever they are.
I will use my lungs to instruct the novice and bring cheer to the ill.
And when all fails, and death arrives, it is I who will thank him for the peace given unto the wretched."

Your pledge to the Oath of Lazarus is to the Oath and no other. And though many speak for the Oath takers, there is no one who governs you and no code but your own ethics. Those who have taken the Oath refer to themselves as the Afflicted as a mark of humility. You know that identifying with your patient is intended to serve the easing of their pain. You may have taken the oath early, perhaps you were too immature to understand the fullness of the implications of a lifetime of service. That you would take no family but the refugee, the meek and the ill fated.

But with this life comes a level of access not granted to the rest of the world. For upon the battlefields of war and politics there is no shield greater than the healer who bares the traditional cilice upon their leg.This ancient form of self atonement steadys the hand of the surgeon and merchant alike. For though one of the afflicted may hold any station in life, it is considered gravest taboo to refuse to help any who tug at its chain.

> When any oath is made before one of the Gods of the Round Table, it has been decreed by Sir Cai any who are caught breaking it will be punished. Different chapters employ different methods, but discredited, denied treatment, tar and feathered, put on the rack, or even death may be invoked.

Choose a deity in whose name you will take the oath and work with your DM to work out your path amongst the afflicted. Do you wear the Cilice proudly, or have you grown tired of it as it bites its metal teeth into your flesh day after day? Did the order have a hand in raising you, or did you abandon a life of ease to lessen the guilt of a dark burden? Do you run into the fields of war to give succor despite the many dangers, or do you seek out those who hide their pain? While the origins of the Afflicted remain shrouded by the passing of generations, they have served in every conflict, every tragedy, every life in all of the Old World.

Feature: Burden of Life

Choose a deity in whose name you will take the oath and work with your DM to work out your path amongst the afflicted. Do you wear the Cilice proudly, or have you grown tired of it as it bites its metal teeth into your flesh day after day? Did the order have a hand in raising you, or did you abandon a life of ease to lessen the guilt of a dark burden? Do you run into the fields of war to give succor despite the many dangers, or do you seek out those who hide their pain? While the origins of the Afflicted remain shrouded by the passing of generations, they have served in every conflict, every tragedy, every life in all of the Old World.

It is not unreasonable to assume that a guard could look the other way for an offending Afflicted particularly if that guard had ever been previously injured. A barkeep may waive some fees associated with their tavern for an Afflicted in return for dentistry or lancing boils.

Provided their reputation is unsullied and publicly the Oath is held, they may use any medical facility a populace has available (usually a Church, University, or Large Hall) as temporary residence for themselves, their patients, wards and companions (in that order) if there is room for them. Fellow Afflicted are typically civil to one another. And in the few moments they get to stumble across one another, the stories told over a glass of ale to one another are some of the best you will ever hear.

It falls to you, then, to carry the tradition on to the new world.

Specialty d6

1	Diagnostics
2	Apothecary
3	Surgeon
4	Chiropractic
5	Theraputic
6	Research

Skill Proficiencies: Medicine, Insight
Tool Proficiencies: Herbalism Kit, Alchemy Kit
Equipment: a Healer's kit, 2-man tent, bedroll, blanket, Book (About anatomy, disease, apothecary, or surgery), common clothes, five bars of soap, a belt pouch containing 5 gp.



Suggested Characteristics

d6 Personality Trait

1 All I think about is saving lives, or lives that have been lost.

2 I swore the Oath in the name of my religion, nation, or clan.

3 I am cold and calculating in my every word and action, even when furious or frightened.

4 When even the slightest malody or symptom appears, I take immediate action.

5 I consider magical healers and healing either to be cheating and unaccountable, or an integral future counterpart of a greater medical art.

6 I am waging a personal war on death itself.

7 I am entranced and inspired by the brilliance and glory of the living body.

8 I am actively involved in the medical society and engage in theoretical discourse and debate.

d6 Ideals

1 **Life.** I was put on this world to protect and save life (Good)

2 **Duty.** I swore the Oath, and I must live by its tenets. (Lawful)

3 **Vigilantism.** No man can dictate who shall die, when or howl (Chaotic)

4 **Profit.** Is it really my fault that all who come to me suffering also come bearing compensation? (Evil)

5 **Survival.** We are all in this together, for better or for worse. (Neutral)

6 **Right.** Everyone deserves to live. (Neutral)

d6 Bonds

1 I owe everything to my home village/clan, for pooling their resources to have me educated.

2 I was pushed, or encouraged, into taking the oath by my parents.

3 My professor is the most most important person in the world to me.

4 My patients are my everything- losing one of them is like dying, but it never ends.

5 I took up the Oath because someone close to me died of something treatable.

6 I started my training alone from texts I obtained by my own means.

d6 Flaws

1 I took the Oath not realizing its full implications.

2 No one can know that I have broken the Oath.

3 I feel contempt for many of my patients.

4 I think I am better than others in general for taking the Oath.

5 Sometimes I go too far in my search for knowledge.

6 I am frightened/sickened by human suffering.

Creator's note

The purpose of this document is to provide some backgrounds that are setting appropriate to the colonists of Roanoke. They are not a requirement. More information on 5th edition backgrounds may be found here: https://www.d20srd.org/index.htm